

# Why exactly does AI use so much energy?

Posted by u/Fit-Nectarine5047 • 0 points • 82 comments

I hear this as one of the top complaints and issues with AI but why does it use more energy than anything else?

## Comments

u/Alarming\_Swan6270 • 2 points • 2026-02-04 16:02 UTC

AI needs so much energy, not because it's "hyped", but because its rapid expansion is tied to **real-world physical infrastructure**, large data centres, electrical networks and industrial-scale systems, all of which consume electricity continuously and at a scale similar to heavy industry.

[<https://financialintelligence.ro/ian-timis-despre-agenda-globala-a-ai-ului-mineralelor-critice-si-tranzitiei-energetice-cand-capitalul-intalneste-constrangerea/>](<https://financialintelligence.ro/ian-timis-despre-agenda-globala-a-ai-ului-mineralelor-critice-si-tranzitiei-energetice-cand-capitalul-intalneste-constrangerea/>)

u/Fit-Nectarine5047 • 1 points • 2026-01-15 01:17 UTC

Thank you for sharing this!

I've only heard horrible things about Microsoft Copilot so I'm not surprised that whomever is calling the shots there thinks an AI PC is a great idea. A lot of these execs and entrepreneurs see dollar signs first and social welfare NEVER. In my opinion, outside of the medical field (and I'm starting to believe that even that field isn't utilizing the tech correctly) AI doesn't improve a whole lot- certainly not by eradicating the arts, requiring people to use their brains less, etc.

It's just a tool to further entertain and distract and most recently with the rise of vile, predatory sexual content, move the social progress dial back in time. 🙄

u/Concerned4life • 2 points • 2026-01-13 12:02 UTC

Nothing but hard drives working overtime.. and the backup drains energy.

u/fibsthemman • 2 points • 2026-01-13 10:38 UTC

Task: Cook an egg.

An intelligent actor can *reason* how to cook an egg properly, and study how eggs work and common egg recipes, and determine *why* eggs cook wrong when it messes up, to rapidly improve egg-cooking each attempt.

An LLM will cook the egg a totally random amount of time, then mark that amount of time as wrong if the egg is not cooked properly, then cook the next egg a random amount of time but slightly less likely

to be an amount of time it's marked wrong before. It will do this over and over. This \*should\* gradually cook the egg properly more often than chance and improperly less often than chance.

But the intelligent actor will start consistently cooking decent eggs after maybe a dozen eggs, perfect eggs after maybe a hundred eggs, while the LLM will not consistently do well after hundreds of eggs or even thousands. It could take millions of eggs.

To make up for this, the LLM does it really, really fast. It cooks several hundreds of eggs a second, if not thousands. And it just keeps burning through those eggs forever.

What a horrible waste of eggs.

**u/Fit-Nectarine5047** • 1 points • 2026-01-13 11:51 UTC

Wow. I'm even more turned off of societies dependence on AI now. So wasteful!!

**u/LyndinTheAwesome** • 2 points • 2026-01-13 07:15 UTC

The training process requires the analysis of a shitton of data. Which requires a lot of processing power which requires a lot of electricity. The actual process of generating something is not this processing power heavy but there are still a bunch of calculations the systems have to do.

And offcourse Texts require less than photos which require less than videos. And currently the AI companies push towards videos.

**u/Fit-Nectarine5047** • 1 points • 2026-01-13 11:42 UTC

Oh god...

**u/Illustrious-Gas-8987** • 0 points • 2026-01-13 04:43 UTC

You made up a quote that was never said... sure does make you sound like someone just out of school. You should do some self reflection

**u/Fit-Nectarine5047** • 1 points • 2026-01-13 04:55 UTC

What?

**u/green\_meklar** • 1 points • 2026-01-13 03:44 UTC

Because it requires a godawful amount of math and the computers use energy in order to do the math.

**u/Fit-Nectarine5047** • 1 points • 2026-01-13 03:45 UTC

Simple terms. Ty!